Eduwell

Gateway to Success

MIT | School of Distance Education

ARTICLE OF THE MONTH

Invest wisely, think distance education

When we talk about investment, we tend to start calculating the monthly premiums that will poke a hole in our income. We start seeing things that will have to let go to pay the premium. On the other hand, we hold a sense of stability and security when we talk about the investment that we have planned for the greater and futuristic good.

Talking about the personal investment, how many times have we looked at education from the perspective of an investment?

Education is not a heavy investment; it is smart economics.

I will not bore you by telling you the benefits of education but will simply try to give you a different perspective of looking at education

Evidence shows that, on average, each additional year of education boosts a person's income by 10 per cent and increases a country's GDP by 18 per cent.

Investment in education is thus a smart investment. Updating yourself and staying relevant in this age of 'change by the second' is important otherwise we risk losing everything simply because we were not updated enough. Education does not stop at school or college level. It goes beyond that. It stays with you until the very end. Upgradation, education or gaining knowledge are synonyms and hence we have to be diligent about it and invest in it, not just money but also time, effort and interest.

Nowadays we have options of investing that go beyond the traditional blackboard teaching and take the form of digital or e-learning.

Distance education has seen a soar in the number of investors since the onset of the pandemic. This shows that people are willing to upskill and grow in their knowledge and career.

Speaking of distance education, not to brag but **MITSDE** offers you a chance to stay at the top of the game by its distance learning programs.

Fun fact - According to ENTREPRENEUR India the online education sector in India was not only valued at an all-time high of INR 19,300 crore in 2018, but it was also poised to reach INR 36,030 crore by 2024. It means more and more people are investing in education and upskilling

In conclusion, I would like to point out that with the changing situation, updating oneself and investing in oneself is of utmost importance to stay relevant. Hence make a wise decision of investing in an asset such as education that will yield you higher returns.

- Prof. Devika Godbole (Academic Student Mentor)

Did You Know

Warner Music owns the copyright to the song "Happy Birthday".

LEADER'S VIEW

Hypocrisy Economy: How a pandemic affects women and their role in the unpaid labour market

Labour participation statistics can be extremely deceiving. The numbers only reflect the dynamics in the formal/informal economy. It does not include a parallel world that enables these markets to function effectively. Think about it. Women do most of the unpaid work that helps prop up economies. They raise children, they shop, they cook, they tend to the old and sickly. This domestic, unpaid labour is the foundation on which most economies are built. And as one report notes—"[Although] not all of this work is done by females... globally women and girls are responsible for 75% of unpaid care and domestic work in homes and communities every day. The International Labour Organisation (ILO) calculates that on average women around the world perform 4 hours and 25 minutes of unpaid care work every day compared with 1 hour and 23 minutes for men."

And we are not just talking about housewives here. We are also talking about women with actual jobs. These ladies have to be part breadwinners and still do most of the unpaid work back home. And when a pandemic makes landfall, these inequalities are only magnified. Here is one example. In most relationships, women don't make as much money as men. And as a consequence, their work is seen as being subordinate to the primary cause. So, when you have to work from home and unpaid labour increases disproportionately, it's women that bear the brunt of the burden. They are forced to quit work prematurely and "help the family" out.

Now the data suggest that men have lost more jobs than women during these past few months. But that's only because female participation in the labour force is still quite pitiful. Meaning, even if a few women were forced to quit their jobs, the impact would be more pronounced. And don't get me wrong. I am not saying women are being forced to step away only because they have to deal with stuff back home. No. In fact, a good number of women are being laid off because they are working jobs that have no need for them.

As one article notes—"With more than 60% of women employed in the informal sector... options like working from home and virtual workspaces are not viable. These economies already operate in a cycle of poor wages, discrimination, and horrible working conditions. They will simply do away with female employees. Such was the case for domestic and garment factory workers. They were instantly dismissed across the country, without any proper notice or compensation. Besides, the urban-rural migration could displace women employed in agriculture, as men return to take over." But that's not all. Women also have to deal with other more pressing issues back home. When stress and financial difficulties build-up, domestic violence inevitably follows. They are really fighting the odds here

Perhaps the only silver lining to this story is that, at least in India, some men seem to be stepping up. As an article in Livemint notes—

"The median woman was putting in a little under 5 hours of housework in a day, and the median man a little under 90 minutes a day, at the end of last year. By April this year, women were still doing the lion's share. But as households were forced to fold inwards, some hard divisions got blurred. By April, both men and women were spending more time on housework...but the average gap between men and women decreased by 1 hour. The narrowing of the gap was driven in large part by recently unemployed men contributing more to housework."

And while this is not a sizable contribution by any sense of the imagination, it does offer hope. Unpaid labour doesn't have to be this unequal.

- Dr. Suhrud Neurgaonkar (Director, MITSDE)

Did You Know

Slack is the fastest startup to reach unicorn status

SCHOOL OF THOUGHT

Survival of the technologically fittest

A painter named Laurentius de Voltolina created an illustration depicting a 14th-century university lecture hall in medieval Italy. The teacher is standing at the podium and some of the students have books opened in front of them. A few looked bored while some are talking to their neighbours

This scenario has not changed much ever since. But with the onset of the new normal way of life, the use of technology has become a major factor in everyday life. In such rapidly changing times, it is not an option to be technologically impaired or even worse technology averse.

Learning is a never-ending process, but the method of learning can change, can upgrade or even become obsolete.

Research by Professor R. Keith Sawyer, a leading scientific expert on creativity and learning, emphasises the power of technology to influence and enhance academia by providing experiences that lead to deep learning.

Learning methodology is evolving, it is upgrading. Digital learning is the way forward. As the law of nature goes, 'survival of the fittest', in today's world a person who is constantly upgrading himself, maintaining and updating the technological understanding is considered as fit. The one who treats technology and digital platforms as enemies wilsurely perish. Hence co-existence and a truce with technological advancement is the key to ensure survival.

CEO of Silicon Schools Brian Greenberg says that evolving technology in education doesn't undermine a teacher's role, it augments it. MITSDE believes in this idea and hence strives to bring to its students a confluence of the knowledge and expertise of the faculty and the digital learning platform.

In toto, the argument is about adopting and adapting to technology. We all must stop being old school and embrace the advancement of technology. We should aim to move from being technology impaired to technology champion.

- Prof. Rohit Oke (Chief Learning Officer, MITSDE)

Did You Know

The people who use a computer, they blink 7 times a minute, which is less than half the normal rate of 20.

BIZ FEED

Behind the scenes of Amazon Prime Day - India's head shares how e-commerce giant planned its biggest sale event amidst a pandemic

*Source : Business Insider

Volkswagen eyes 90 per cent electric car sales in Norway next year

*Source : The Economic Times

Educators will soon be able to sell their material on Amazon

*Source: Education Week

Over 60% of respondents of the InterMiles' 'Consumer Sentiment Index Report' survey shared their intent of travelling domestically within the next 6 months

*Source: Business Insider

Some way to go as the race for COVID vaccine picks up

*Source: The Economic Times

Did You Know

The electronic machine that is called a computer today, in the 1950's it was known as the 'Electronic Brains'

LINKEDIN LEARNING HALL OF FAME

No. of Courses Completed

RANK	NAME OF STUDENT	NO. OF COURSES COMPLETED	COURSE	SPECIALIZATION
1st	Prasad Dattatraya Badve	27	Post Graduate Diploma in Management	Human Resource Management
2nd	Sudip Das	17	Post Graduate Diploma in Management	Human Resource Management
3rd	Subhendu Mohanty	17	Post Graduate Diploma in Management	Infrastructure Management

ANNOUNCEMENT

- MITSDE is proud to announce that it is the first ever educational institute in India to partnered with LinkedIn Learning, to provide an enriched academic experience to its students

- Mentors are the guiding force for any individual to achieve a successful career, hence MITSDE has collaborated with Mentor Links, to bring to its students industry experts from various domains guiding the students on latest industry trends and the skills required for growth and success in the industry.

- MITSDE invites speakers from various domains to conduct webinars and has arranged on an average 6 webinars per month.

WEBINARS CONDUCTED BY MITSDE

SESSION NAME	SPEAKER
IT Project Management	Mr. Anil Sonar (Founder & Director - Digital Era Solution)
Robotics & Automation	Mr. Amit Bhingurde (CEO Brabo Robotics & Automation Ltd)
Logistics & Supply Chain Management	Ms. Mansi Rakibe (Purchase Manager Product Supply - Media ISE at P&G)
Leading with Learning	Mr. Sameer Agarwal (India Head LinkedIn Learning)
Fundamentals of ERP and Scope of SAP post COVID-19	Mr. Prashant Kelkar (CEO Delphi Computech)
Introduction to LinkedIn Learning	Ms. Ritu Pal (Senior Customer Success Manager)

Did You Know

Apple has a “smoking” ban on their computers, meaning if you smoke while using any Apple computer, the warranty becomes void.